

 Course 1144 Semester I Practicum 5 Credits

# Shorthand English Theory I

A complete handbook for the phonographic system, alternative signs, circles, loops, hooks, shun hooks, and aspirates — with practice exercises, Malayalam support, and exam preparation.

**Programme**

Commercial Practice

**Subject Code**

1144

**Subject Title**

Shorthand English Theory I

**Semester**

I

**Course Type**

Practicum

**Contact Hours**

105

**Teaching Scheme**

3:0:4:0 (L:T:P:R)

**Credits**

5

**CIE Marks**

40

**ESE Marks**

60



## Official Source Declaration

This handbook is based on the official Kerala Polytechnic Revision 2026 syllabus for Course 1144 — Shorthand English Theory I.

**⚠ Verified Inconsistencies:** The syllabus document contains minor formatting irregularities in the teaching scheme table (repeated "1" characters on pages 3 and 6) and some module-hour totals that appear as "120" for lecture hours rather than instructional-hour counts. These have been interpreted as 12 hours of theory instruction per module (120 minutes of lecture per week) based on the contact-hour breakdown. The practice exercises listed in each module are treated as practical (P) hours. All official content has been preserved as listed.

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**Total Pages:** 6

**Revision:** 2026

**Course Code:** 1144



## Course Dashboard

**105**

CONTACT HOURS

**5**

CREDITS

**40+60**

CIE + ESE MARKS

**4**

MODULES



### Course Pre-requisite

Basic Knowledge in English grammar and composition — Secondary Education



### Introduction

Shorthand English is an abbreviated, symbolic writing method that increases writing speed compared to standard "longhand". It enables writers to keep pace with spoken language

and is commonly used by journalists, secretaries, and court reporters for note-taking and documentation.

Teaching and Assessment Scheme

| Teaching Scheme/Week | Self-learning (SS)/Week | Total Hours/Semester | Credits C | Theory |     |       | Practical |     |       |
|----------------------|-------------------------|----------------------|-----------|--------|-----|-------|-----------|-----|-------|
|                      |                         |                      |           | CIE    | ESE | Total | CIE       | ESE | Total |
| 3:0:4:0              | 6.5                     | 105                  | 5         | 20     | 40  | 60    | 20        | 40  | 60    |

L: Lecture (one unit = one hour, one credit), T: Tutorial (one unit = one hour, one credit), P: Practical (one unit = one hour, 0.5 credit), R: Project (one unit = one hour, 0.5 credit), SS: Self-Learning, CIE: Continuous Internal Evaluation, ESE: End Semester Examination

## How to Use This Handbook

A four-step approach to mastering Shorthand English Theory I.

### 1 Understand

Read each module's theory, definitions, and principles carefully. Use the Malayalam notes for clarity.

### 2 Visualise

Study the shorthand outlines and diagrams. Practice writing strokes and circles as shown.

### 3 Apply

Work through every practice exercise listed. Use the calculators and self-learning activities to reinforce learning.

### 4 Revise

Use the quick revision cards, module-wise questions, and model paper to test your readiness for exams.

## Course Objectives & Outcomes

### Objectives

1. To provide a thorough knowledge in Shorthand English Theory.
2. To get fundamental knowledge in the phonographic system.
3. To enable students to convert text to shorthand.
4. To read printed or written shorthand with ease and accuracy.
5. To attain speed in shorthand writing through practicing exercises.
6. To improve the English language of the students.

### Course Outcomes (CO)

| CO  | Course Outcome                                                                                | Bloom's Level |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| CO1 | Apply basic knowledge of phonography system                                                   | Apply         |
| CO2 | Make use of alternatives signs for R & H, diphthongs, phraseography, and circles in shorthand | Apply         |
| CO3 | Identify loops and hooks                                                                      | Apply         |
| CO4 | Apply shun hooks, aspirates                                                                   | Apply         |

## CO-PO Mapping

Course Articulation Matrix

| CO  | PO1 | PO2 | PO3 | PO4 | PO5 | PO6 | PO7 | PO8 | PO9 | PO10 | PO11 | PO12 |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|------|------|
| CO1 | 1   | -   | -   | -   | -   | -   | -   | 3   | -   | -    | -    | -    |
| CO2 | -   | 2   | -   | -   | -   | -   | -   | 3   | -   | -    | -    | -    |
| CO3 | -   | 2   | -   | -   | -   | 1   | 3   | -   | -   | -    | -    | -    |
| CO4 | -   | -   | -   | -   | -   | 1   | 3   | -   | -   | 1    | -    | -    |

Legends: 1 — Low; 2 — Medium; 3 — High; No Correlation — "-"

## Curriculum Coverage Map

Module-wise coverage with hours, COs, and handbook anchors

| Module | Title                                                            | Lecture Hrs | Practice Hrs | CO  | Section  |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|--------------|-----|----------|
| I      | Basic knowledge of phonography system                            | 12          | 16           | CO1 | Module 1 |
| II     | Alternatives signs for R & H, diphthongs, phraseography, circles | 12          | 16           | CO2 | Module 2 |
| III    | Loops and hooks                                                  | 12          | 16           | CO3 | Module 3 |
| IV     | Shun hooks, aspirates                                            | 9           | 12           | CO4 | Module 4 |

## How the Modules Connect

A logical progression from basic phonography to advanced shorthand constructions.

### 1 Module I — Foundations

Phonographic system, consonants, vowels, grammalogues. The building blocks of shorthand.

### 2 Module II — Alternative Forms

R/H alternatives, diphthongs, phraseography, circle S/Z. Extending the shorthand system.

### 3 Module III — Loops & Hooks

Abbreviated forms, initial/final hooks, FR/VR alternatives, circle+hook combinations.

### 4 Module IV — Advanced

Shun hooks, aspirates, essay writing. Applying all principles in connected text.

#### MODULE I

## Basic Knowledge of Phonography System

Understanding the foundational building blocks of Pitman Shorthand — consonants, vowels, vowel signs, and grammalogues.



12 Lecture Hours



16 Practice Hours



CO1



Bloom: Apply

## ►Phonographic System

The **phonographic system** is the foundation of Pitman Shorthand. Unlike alphabetical writing (longhand) which represents letters, phonography represents *sounds* of spoken language. It is a **phonetic** system — words are written as they sound, not as they are spelled.

**Key Concept:** "Write what you hear, not what you see." Shorthand is based on pronunciation, not spelling.

### Principles of Phonography

**Sound-based:** Each symbol represents a sound (phoneme), not a letter.

**Light and heavy strokes:** Differentiate voiced and unvoiced sounds.

**Position writing:** Vowels are indicated by the position of the stroke relative to the line of writing.

**Consonantal skeleton:** The outline represents the consonants of a word; vowels are added as needed.

#### EXAMPLE

**Word "cat":** In phonography, we write the consonant sounds K and T. The vowel A is indicated by the position of the stroke — written above the line.

**Malayalam support:** Phonography ഏകദേശം ശബ്ദങ്ങൾക്ക് പ്രത്യേക ചിഹ്നങ്ങൾ ഉപയോഗിക്കുന്നു. "Cat" എന്ന വാക്ക് ഫോണോഗ്രാഫിക് ചിഹ്നം K + T എന്നീ ശബ്ദങ്ങൾ ഉപയോഗിച്ച് എഴുതാം, A എന്ന ശബ്ദ-സ്ഥിതി ചിഹ്നം ഉപയോഗിച്ച്.

## ► Consonants — Meaning, Arrangement, Classes, and Groups

**Consonants** are speech sounds produced with partial or complete closure of the vocal tract. In Pitman Shorthand, consonants are represented by **strokes** — straight or curved lines drawn in specific directions.

## Arrangement of Groups

Consonants are arranged in **pairs** of light and heavy strokes:

**Light strokes** represent unvoiced consonants (e.g., P, T, CH, K, F, TH, S, SH)

**Heavy strokes** represent voiced consonants (e.g., B, D, J, G, V, DH, Z, ZH)

## Consonant Pairs — Light and Heavy Strokes

| Unvoiced (Light) | Voiced (Heavy) | Stroke Type       |
|------------------|----------------|-------------------|
| P                | B              | Straight downward |
| T                | D              | Straight downward |
| CH               | J              | Curved            |
| K                | G              | Straight downward |
| F                | V              | Curved            |
| TH               | DH             | Curved            |
| S                | Z              | Circle/Stroke     |
| SH               | ZH             | Curved            |

## Classes of Consonants

Consonants are grouped into **classes** based on where in the mouth they are formed:

**Labials:** P, B — formed with lips

**Dentals:** T, D — formed with tongue against teeth

**Gutturals:** K, G — formed in the throat

**Palatals:** CH, J — formed with tongue against hard palate

**Labio-dentals:** F, V — formed with lip and teeth

**Dento-labials:** TH, DH — formed with tongue between teeth

**Sibilants:** S, Z, SH, ZH — hissed sounds

**Practice Exercises 1-4:** Write the consonants in pairs, practice the stroke directions, and identify voiced/unvoiced pairs.

**Remember:** The direction of the stroke matters — each consonant has a specific direction. Practice with the instructor's key to ensure correct formation.

**Malayalam support:** Consonants (പ്രാഥമികം) — light strokes (പ്രാഥമികം പ്രാഥമികം) unvoiced sounds-പ്രാ, heavy strokes (പ്രാഥമികം പ്രാഥമികം) voiced sounds-പ്രാ പ്രാഥമികം പ്രാഥമികം. P/B, T/D, K/G പ്രാഥമികം പ്രാഥമികം പ്രാഥമികം.

►Vowels — Sounds, Signs, Placing, and Intervening Vowels

**Vowels** are speech sounds produced without obstruction of the vocal tract. In Pitman Shorthand, vowels are represented by **dots** and **dashes** placed in specific positions relative to the consonant stroke.

Vowel Sounds

There are **six long vowels** and **six short vowels** in English phonetic shorthand:

| Vowel Sounds with Examples |             |                             |
|----------------------------|-------------|-----------------------------|
| Sound                      | Example     | Symbol                      |
| ē (long E)                 | beet, see   | Dot (light)                 |
| ĭ (short I)                | bit, sit    | Dot (heavy)                 |
| ā (long A)                 | bait, say   | Dash (light)                |
| ĕ (short E)                | bet, set    | Dash (heavy)                |
| ä (long A)                 | father, arm | Dot (light — 3rd position)  |
| ō (short O)                | not, hot    | Dash (heavy — 3rd position) |

Vowel Signs and Placing

Vowel signs are placed at **three positions** relative to the consonant stroke:

**First position:** Before the stroke (beginning of word) — e.g., "ate" = vowel before consonant

**Second position:** At the stroke (middle of word) — e.g., "bat" = vowel at the stroke

**Third position:** After the stroke (end of word) — e.g., "bait" = vowel after consonant

EXAMPLE

**Word "be":** B stroke (heavy, downward) + light dot (ē) at the stroke → the outline represents "be".

**Word "bit":** B stroke + heavy dot (ĭ) at the stroke + T stroke (light, downward).

Intervening Vowels

**Intervening vowels** are vowels that occur between two consonants. They are indicated by the **position of the following stroke** relative to the previous stroke, rather than by a separate vowel sign.

**Key Principle:** In connected shorthand, vowels are often implied by the position of strokes rather than written explicitly. This increases writing speed.

**Practice Exercises 5-12:** Practice vowel identification, placing vowel signs, and reading words with intervening vowels.



**Malayalam support:** Vowels (വ്യഞ്ജനങ്ങൾ) — dot (പിന്നാലി) and dash (പിന്നാലി) are used as symbols. Position 1 (beginning), Position 2 (middle), Position 3 (end) വ്യഞ്ജനങ്ങൾ vowels-പിന്നാലി and dash (പിന്നാലി) are used as symbols.

►Grammalogues and Punctuations

**Grammalogues** are frequently occurring words that are represented by a single shorthand sign (a stroke, a circle, or a tick). They form the "common words" that speed up writing significantly.

Common Grammalogues

| Important Grammalogues |                         |                        |
|------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|
| Word                   | Shorthand Sign          | Usage                  |
| and                    | Light slanting stroke   | Conjunction            |
| of                     | Light horizontal stroke | Preposition            |
| for                    | Heavy slanting stroke   | Preposition            |
| to                     | Light tick              | Preposition/Infinitive |
| with                   | Circle                  | Preposition            |
| the                    | Heavy tick              | Article                |
| you                    | Light stroke            | Pronoun                |
| I                      | Light stroke            | Pronoun                |

Punctuation in Shorthand

- Period (.)** : Light horizontal tick
- Comma (,)** : Light upward stroke
- Question mark (?)** : Dot with a tick
- Exclamation (!)** : Heavy dot with a downward stroke

**Exam Tip:** Grammalogues are the most frequently tested items in theory exams. Memorise at least 50 common grammalogues for high-speed writing.

**Malayalam support:** Grammalogues (വ്യഞ്ജനങ്ങൾ) — "and", "of", "for", "to", "with", "the" വ്യഞ്ജനങ്ങൾ single strokes വ്യഞ്ജനങ്ങൾ. They speed up writing significantly.

## ►General Knowledge — Current Affairs and Who's Who

As shorthand is used in journalism, legal reporting, and administrative documentation, general knowledge — particularly **current affairs** and **who's who** — is essential for:

Understanding context in dictation passages

Spelling names and terms correctly in transcription

Recognising abbreviations and acronyms

### Recommended Areas of GK for Shorthand Students

**Government:** President, Prime Minister, Chief Ministers, Governors

**International:** UN, WHO, World Bank, IMF heads

**Business:** Major companies, stock exchanges, economic indicators

**Sports:** Major tournaments, record holders

**Science:** Nobel Prize winners, major discoveries

**Self-Learning Activity:** Prepare 20 MCQs relating to current affairs. This helps in understanding dictation passages and improving general awareness.

**Malayalam support:** Current affairs (സമകാലിക സാഹചര്യങ്ങൾ) — shorthand dictation-  
ശ്രവണ ശേഷി വർദ്ധിപ്പിക്കുന്നതിനായി സമകാലിക സാഹചര്യങ്ങൾ ശ്രവണ ശേഷി വർദ്ധിപ്പിക്കുന്നതിനായി.   
transcription accuracy വർദ്ധിപ്പിക്കുന്നതിനായി.

 **Module I Summary:** Phonography is sound-based writing. Consonants are stroke pairs (light/unvoiced, heavy/voiced). Vowels are dots/dashes in three positions. Grammalogues are single-sign common words. Practice exercises 1-12 build the foundation.

#### MODULE II

## Alternatives for R & H, Diphthongs, Phraseography, and Circles

Extending the shorthand system with alternative signs for R and H, diphthongs, phraseography, and the use of circles for S and Z.

 12 Lecture Hours

 16 Practice Hours

 CO2

 Bloom: Apply

## ► Alternatives of R and H

In Pitman Shorthand, **R** and **H** have alternative representations depending on their position in a word and the surrounding strokes.

### Alternative Forms of R

**Regular R:** A curved stroke (initial, medial, or final)

**R Hook:** A small hook added to a stroke to represent R after the consonant

**R Circle:** A circle used to represent R in certain combinations

**R Upward:** Used in words like "are" as a grammalogue

### Alternative Forms of H

**Regular H:** A light downward stroke

**H Hook:** A small hook added to a stroke to represent H before a vowel

**Aspirate H:** In certain dialects, H is represented by a specific stroke

#### EXAMPLE

**Word "try":** T stroke + R hook = single outline for "try".

**Word "who":** H stroke (aspirate) + circle for 'oo' sound.

**Key Rule:** Use the alternative form that is most efficient for the combination of letters. Practice helps identify which form to use.

**Malayalam support:** R-ര alternative forms (hook, circle, upward) — word-രൂരൂ രൂരൂ രൂരൂരൂരൂരൂരൂ രൂരൂരൂരൂരൂ. H-ഹ aspirate form ഹ hook ഹ രൂരൂരൂരൂരൂരൂരൂരൂരൂ.

►Diphthongs and Triphones

**Diphthongs** are vowel sounds that consist of a **glide** from one vowel to another within the same syllable. In Pitman Shorthand, diphthongs are represented by **two vowel signs joined** by a light curve.

Common Diphthongs

| Diphthongs and Their Representations |               |                  |
|--------------------------------------|---------------|------------------|
| Diphthong                            | Example       | Symbol           |
| ī (as in "ice")                      | ice, my, high | Light dot + dash |
| ou (as in "out")                     | out, now, how | Heavy dash + dot |
| oi (as in "oil")                     | oil, boy, toy | Dot + tick       |
| ow (as in "own")                     | own, go, show | Dash + tick      |

Triphones

**Triphones** are three-vowel glides (rare in English). They are represented by **combining diphthong symbols** with an additional vowel sign.

**Remember:** Diphthongs and triphones are written as **one unit** with a single connecting stroke. This saves space and increases speed.

**Malayalam support:** Diphthongs (എയി, ഐ, ഔ, ഓ) — "ice", "out", "oil" ഐ, ഔ, ഓ vowel glides. Triphones — three vowels in one syllable.

## ►Phraseography — Principles and Qualities of Good Phraseograms

**Phraseography** is the art of writing two or more words as **one outline** (a phraseogram). This dramatically increases shorthand speed.

### Principles of Phraseography

**Common phrases:** Write frequent word combinations as one unit — "I am", "you will", "in the", etc.

**Grammalogues in phrases:** Combine grammalogues with other strokes — "and the", "of the", "for the"

**Position writing:** The position of the phraseogram indicates the overall meaning

**Intersecting strokes:** Use strokes that intersect or touch to form phraseograms

### Qualities of a Good Phraseogram

**Legibility:** Must be immediately readable

**Speed:** Should be faster than writing words separately

**Consistency:** Should follow predictable rules

**Distinctiveness:** Should not be confused with other phraseograms

#### EXAMPLES OF COMMON PHRASEOGRAMS

**"I am":** Light stroke for "I" + heavy stroke for "am" (combined)

**"in the":** Circle for "in" + heavy tick for "the"

**"you will":** Stroke for "you" + upward stroke for "will"

**Practice:** Practice grammalogues and exercises 13, 15, 17, 19, 21, 22, 23, 25, 28, 30, 31, and 34 for phraseography.

**Malayalam support:** Phraseography — ഫ്രേഗ്രാഫി. "I am" ഫ്രേഗ്രാഫി ഔട്ട്ലൈൻ ഫ്രേഗ്രാഫി. ഫ്രേഗ്രാഫി speed ഫ്രേഗ്രാഫി ഫ്രേഗ്രാഫി.

►Circles — S and Z, Large Circles, Stroke S and Z

In Pitman Shorthand, the **circle** represents the sound of **S** or **Z**. The circle is one of the most versatile and frequently used signs.

Circle S and Z

**Small circle:** Represents the sound of S or Z

**Large circle:** Represents the sound of S and Z together (as in "size", "seize")

**Placement:** The circle can be placed at the beginning, middle, or end of a stroke

Comparing Circle S and Stroke S

**Circle S:** Used when S is a separate sound, often at the end of a word (e.g., "books" — B+K+S with circle)

**Stroke S:** Used when S is the main consonant (e.g., "see", "so") or in certain combinations

Circle S/Z Usage

| Type         | Position            | Example             |
|--------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| Small circle | End of stroke       | "books" (B + K + S) |
| Small circle | Beginning of stroke | "sack" (S + K)      |
| Large circle | Between strokes     | "size" (S + Z)      |

**Memory Aid:** If the S sound is just an "extra" sound, use a circle. If S is the main consonant, use the stroke.

**Malayalam support:** Circle S/Z — "books" (B+K+S) ബുക്സ് S circle സിർക്. "see" സീ S stroke സി ബുക്സ് സി.

## ►Writing Formal and Informal Letters

Shorthand is extensively used for drafting and transcribing correspondence. Understanding the structure of formal and informal letters is essential.

### Formal Letter Structure

**Sender's address:** Top right/left

**Date:** Below sender's address

**Recipient's address:** Left side

**Subject line:** "Sub:" or "Re:"

**Salutation:** "Dear Sir/Madam," "Respected..."

**Body:** Formal language, structured paragraphs

**Complimentary close:** "Yours faithfully," "Yours sincerely,"

**Signature:** Name and designation

### Informal Letter Structure

**Sender's address:** Less formal, often omitted

**Date:** Casual format

**Salutation:** "Dear [Name]," "Hi [Name],"

**Body:** Conversational, shorter paragraphs

**Complimentary close:** "Yours lovingly," "With love," "Regards,"

**Signature:** First name only

**Self-Learning Activity:** Write one sample formal and one informal letter in shorthand. Practice transcribing them back to longhand.

**Malayalam support:** Formal letter — official correspondence-പ്രാമാണ്യപത്രം. Informal letter — personal correspondence-പ്രാണികപത്രം. Shorthand-ശുദ്ധം letter writing speed വേഗം.

 **Module II Summary:** Alternative forms for R/H reduce outline length. Diphthongs combine two vowel sounds. Phraseography writes multiple words as one. Circles represent S/Z efficiently. Practice exercises 13-34 reinforce these principles.

## MODULE III

# Loops and Hooks

Understanding loops as abbreviated forms, initial and final hooks, alternative forms FR/VR, and combinations with circles.

 12 Lecture Hours

 16 Practice Hours

 CO3

 Bloom: Apply

►Loops — Initial, Medial, and Final Positions

**Loops** are curved extensions added to strokes to represent certain consonant combinations. They function as **abbreviated forms** to save space and increase speed.

**Position of Loops**

**Initial loop:** Added at the beginning of a stroke — represents "ST" or "STR"

**Medial loop:** Added in the middle of a stroke — represents "R" or "L"

**Final loop:** Added at the end of a stroke — represents "TR" or "DR"

Loops and Their Meanings

| Loop Type        | Position            | Represents | Example                    |
|------------------|---------------------|------------|----------------------------|
| Small final loop | End of stroke       | TR         | "better" (B + T with loop) |
| Large final loop | End of stroke       | DR         | "fader" (F + D with loop)  |
| Initial loop     | Beginning of stroke | ST         | "stay" (ST + A)            |

**EXAMPLE**

**Word "better":** B (heavy downward stroke) + small final loop = outline for "better" (B + T + R).

**Word "stay":** Initial loop + T (light downward stroke) + vowel placement = outline for "stay".

**Self-Learning:** Prepare a list of 15 words using loops other than the textbook to practice identifying loop positions.

**Malayalam support:** Loops (ലൂപ്പുകൾ) — shorthand-ൽ ചുരുക്കരേഖകൾ abbreviated forms. Initial, medial, final ലൂപ്പുകൾ positions-ൽ ലൂപ്പുകൾ ചുരുക്കരേഖകൾ. "better" ലൂപ്പുകൾ final loop ചുരുക്കരേഖകൾ.



## ►Initial Hooks and Final Hooks

**Hooks** are small curved additions to strokes that represent additional consonants. They are classified as **initial hooks** (added at the beginning) and **final hooks** (added at the end).

### Initial Hooks

Added at the **beginning** of a stroke

Represent consonants like **R, L, or W**

Common in words beginning with "pr", "pl", "br", "bl", "kr", "kl", etc.

### Final Hooks

Added at the **end** of a stroke

Represent consonants like **R, L, N, or F/V**

Common in words ending with "er", "or", "el", "le", "en", "on", etc.

#### EXAMPLES

**"pray":** P (heavy stroke) + initial R hook

**"play":** P (heavy stroke) + initial L hook

**"maker":** M (heavy stroke) + K (light stroke) + final R hook

**"fable":** F (light curved stroke) + B (heavy stroke) + final L hook

**Self-Learning:** Prepare a list of 20 words using hooks other than the textbook to practice hook identification and formation.

**Malayalam support:** Initial hooks (പ്രാർ, പ്ലാർ) — "pray", "play" പ്ലാർ R/L hook. Final hooks (മാർ, ഫാർ) — "maker", "fable" പ്ലാർ R/L hook.

## ►Alternative Forms FR and VR

In Pitman Shorthand, **FR** and **VR** have special alternative forms that are more efficient than writing F+V/R separately.

### FR Alternative

Represented by an **F stroke with an initial R hook** — or a **curved stroke** combining both sounds

Used in words like "free", "front", "friend"

### VR Alternative

Represented by a **V stroke with an initial R hook** — or a **curved stroke** combining both sounds

Used in words like "very", "various", "virtue"

#### EXAMPLES

**"free":** F (light curved stroke) + initial R hook = single outline for "free"

**"very":** V (heavy curved stroke) + initial R hook + vowel placement

**Key Rule:** The FR/VR alternatives are used when the R sound follows immediately after F or V. This is more efficient than writing two separate strokes.

**Malayalam support:** FR/VR alternatives — "free", "very" ഫ്രീ വരി F/V stroke-ഫ്രീ വരി R hook ഫ്രീ വരി single outline ഫ്രീ വരി.

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## ►Circle or Loop Preceding Initial Hooks

When a **circle (S/Z)** or a **loop (ST/STR)** precedes a stroke that already has an initial hook, the outline becomes more complex. Understanding the **order of addition** is crucial.

### Rules for Circle/Loop + Hook Combinations

**Circle first:** If the word starts with S/Z, write the circle *before* the hook

**Loop first:** If the word starts with ST/STR, write the loop *before* the hook

The hook is added to the stroke *after* the circle/loop

#### EXAMPLES

**"spring":** S circle + P (heavy stroke) + R hook + stroke for "ing"

**"strong":** ST loop + R hook + stroke for "ong"

**"screen":** S circle + K (heavy stroke) + R hook + stroke for "een"

**Practice:** Identifying circles with hooks in different motions requires dedicated practice. Exercise 35, 37, revisionary exercise A, and exercises 39-58 cover these combinations.

**Malayalam support:** Circle/loop + initial hook — "spring", "strong" സ്പ്രിംഗ് S/ST ഫ്രോം, ഫ്രോം ഹുക്ക്. Order of writing സ്പ്രിംഗ് ഫ്രോം ഹുക്ക്.

►N and F/V Hooks to Straight and Curved Strokes

Hooks for **N** and **F/V** can be added to both straight and curved strokes, with different positions depending on the stroke shape.

**N Hook**

Represents the sound of **N** or **EN/ON**

Added at the **end** of a stroke

**To straight strokes:** Hook is on the *same side* as the circle

**To curved strokes:** Hook follows the curve direction

**F/V Hook**

Represents the sound of **F** or **V** (or "ove", "ive")

Added at the **end** of a stroke

**To straight strokes:** Hook is on the *opposite side* from the circle

**To curved strokes:** Hook follows the natural curve direction

Hook Types for Straight and Curved Strokes

| Hook     | Straight Stroke Position  | Curved Stroke Position | Example             |
|----------|---------------------------|------------------------|---------------------|
| N hook   | Same side as circle       | Inner curve            | "pen" (P + N hook)  |
| F/V hook | Opposite side from circle | Outer curve            | "have" (H + V hook) |

**Key Distinction:** The side of the hook is critical — N hook and F/V hook are on *opposite* sides of straight strokes. This distinction prevents confusion in reading.

**Malayalam support:** N hook (N ഹുക്ക്) — circle ഹുക്ക് ഹുക്ക്. F/V hook (F/V ഹുക്ക്) — circle ഹുക്ക് ഹുക്ക്. ് distinction reading accuracy-ഹുക്ക് ഹുക്ക്.

## ►Circles and Loops to Final Hooks

When a stroke has a **final hook**, a **circle (S/Z)** or **loop (ST/STR)** can be added to create more complex outlines.

### Rules for Final Hook + Circle/Loop

**Circle after final hook:** The circle is written *after* the final hook — represents "S" or "Z" at the end

**Loop after final hook:** The loop is written *after* the final hook — represents "STR" at the end  
The order is: **Stroke → Final Hook → Circle/Loop**

#### EXAMPLES

**"letters":** L + T (with final hook for R) + circle for S

**"monsters":** M + N (with final hook for T/ST) + loop for STR + circle for S

**Practice:** Exercises 50, 52, 54, 56, and 58 cover circles and loops with final hooks. Practice identifying the order of addition.

**Malayalam support:** Final hook + circle/loop — "letters" ഐലിംഗ് L + T (R hook) + S circle. Order of writing: stroke → final hook → circle/loop.

📖 **Module III Summary:** Loops (initial/medial/final) abbreviate ST/STR/TR/DR. Hooks (initial/final) add R/L/N/F/V. FR/VR have special forms. Circle/loop + hook combinations require careful order. Practice exercises 35-58 build proficiency.

#### MODULE IV

## Shun Hooks and Aspirates

Applying advanced principles of shun hooks, aspirates, and essay writing to produce fluent shorthand.

📖 9 Lecture Hours

✎ 12 Practice Hours

🎯 CO4

📊 Bloom: Apply

## ► Principles Covering Shun Hooks

**"Shun" hooks** are hooks that represent the sound **-tion, -sion, -ssion, -cian, -tian** — words ending with the "shun" sound (e.g., "nation", "mission", "physician").

## Key Principles

The "shun" sound is represented by a **final hook** added to the last consonant stroke

The hook is placed on the **opposite side** from the circle (if present)

Words ending with "-tion" are written as: **consonant stroke + shun hook**

Words ending with "-sion" may require an additional circle before the hook

## Shun Hook Examples

| Word      | Shorthand Outline          | Hook Type                  |
|-----------|----------------------------|----------------------------|
| nation    | N + shun hook              | Final hook (opposite side) |
| mission   | M + circle (S) + shun hook | Final hook with circle     |
| physician | F + SH stroke + shun hook  | Final hook                 |

### EXAMPLE: "NATION"

**N** (heavy downward stroke) + shun hook on the *opposite side* from the circle = outline for "nation".

This distinguishes it from "notion" (N + shun hook on the same side).

**Key Rule:** The side of the shun hook is critical for distinguishing different "-tion" words. Practice writing and reading shun hooks carefully.

**Malayalam support:** Shun hooks — "-tion", "-sion" endings. "nation" (N + shun hook), "mission" (M + S circle + shun hook). Hook-ശ്ശ side reading-ശ്ശ ശ്ശശ്ശശ്ശശ്ശശ്ശ.

►Aspirates in Shorthand — Different Forms

**Aspirates** are sounds produced with a **breath of air** (like the 'h' in "hat"). In shorthand, aspirates have specific representations.

**Forms of Aspirates**

- Regular H:** A light downward stroke — used for words beginning with 'h' like "hat", "him"
- H Hook:** A hook added to a stroke to represent H before a vowel — used in words like "who", "whom"
- Aspirate with vowel:** The aspirate sound combined with a vowel sign
- Silent H:** When H is silent (e.g., "hour", "honest"), no aspirate sign is written

Aspirate Forms

| Form             | Representation           | Example                     |
|------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Regular H        | Light downward stroke    | "hat" (H + A + T)           |
| H Hook           | Hook on a stroke         | "who" (W + H hook)          |
| Aspirate + vowel | H stroke with vowel sign | "her" (H + vowel placement) |

**Remember:** Not all 'h' sounds are aspirated in English. Words like "hour", "honest", "heir" have a silent h — no aspirate sign is used.

**Malayalam support:** Aspirates (ആസ്പിരേറ്റുകൾ) — 'h' ശബ്ദം. Regular H, H hook ആസ്പിരേറ്റുകൾ-aspirates-ആസ്പിരേറ്റുകൾ. Silent H (hour, honest) — aspirate sign ആസ്പിരേറ്റുകൾ.

## ►Principles of Essay Writing in Shorthand

Essay writing in shorthand requires **planning, structure, and execution** — applying all the shorthand principles learned in Modules I–IV.

### Essay Writing Requirements

**Topic understanding:** Read and understand the essay prompt fully

**Planning:** Outline the key points before writing

**Structure:** Introduction → Body (3–4 paragraphs) → Conclusion

**Speed:** Maintain consistent speed while ensuring legibility

**Accuracy:** Correct grammar, spelling, punctuation in transcription

### Principles of Good Essay Writing in Shorthand

**Write in phrases:** Use phraseography to increase speed

**Use grammalogues:** Apply all grammalogues correctly

**Maintain position:** Vowel placement should be consistent

**Review and proofread:** Check transcription against the original dictation

**Practice:** Practice passages including grammalogues. Transcribe passages to longhand from newspapers to build speed and accuracy.

**Malayalam support:** Essay writing — shorthand- structure, speed, accuracy .  
Phraseography, grammalogues speed  
.

**Module IV Summary:** Shun hooks represent "-tion/-sion" endings. Aspirates represent 'h' sounds. Essay writing applies all shorthand principles. Practice exercises 59, 61, 63, 65, and 67 reinforce these advanced concepts.



## Formula Bank

Key shorthand principles and rules organised for quick reference.

### Consonant Pairs

Light = Unvoiced (P,T,CH,K,F,TH,S,SH)

Heavy = Voiced (B,D,J,G,V,DH,Z,ZH)

### Vowel Positions



Position 1: Before stroke (beginning)

Position 2: At stroke (middle)

Position 3: After stroke (end)

### Circle S/Z

Small circle = S or Z

Large circle = S + Z together

### Loops

Initial = ST/STR

Medial = R/L

Final = TR/DR

### Hooks

Initial hooks = R/L/W

Final hooks = R/L/N/F/V

Shun hooks = -tion/-sion

### Phraseography

Common phrases as one outline

Grammalogues + strokes

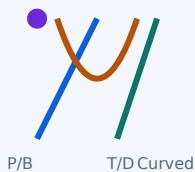
Intersecting/touching strokes



## Visual Library — Diagram Reference

Key diagrams from each module for rapid revision.

### Consonant Stroke Directions



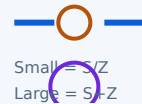
P/B

T/D Curved

### Vowel Signs



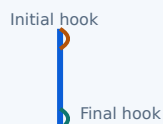
### Circle S/Z



Small = S/Z

Large = S+Z

### Hook Positions



Initial hook

Final hook



## Self-Learning Activities

Official activities for self-learning, organised by module.

### Module I — Activities (Weeks 1-4)

- **Week 1:** Write a set of words and read the consonants according to the phonography (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 2:** Identify the vowels and read the words from the given sets of words (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 3:** Identify vowel places and write the words from the given sets of words (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 4:** Prepare 20 MCQs relating to current affairs; Practice exercises up to vowels (6.5 hrs)

### Module II — Activities (Weeks 5-8)

- **Week 5:** Activities for identifying and writing circles in words (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 6:** Identify diphthongs and triphones from sets of words (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 7:** Write one sample formal and informal letter (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 8:** Prepare a comparative chart showing formal Vs informal letter outlines in shorthand (6.5 hrs)

### Module III — Activities (Weeks 9-12)

- **Week 9:** Prepare a list of 15 words using loops other than text book (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 10:** Prepare a list of 20 words using hooks other than text book (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 11:** Activities for identifying circles with hooks in different motions (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 12:** Write and compare different hooks; Practice exercises in hooks (6.5 hrs)

### Module IV — Activities (Weeks 13-15)

- **Week 13:** Activities for identifying kinds of aspirates (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 14:** Write essays on different relevant topics (6.5 hrs)
- **Week 15:** Practice passages including grammalogues; Transcribe passages to longhand from newspapers (6.5 hrs)



## Assessment Methodology

### Practicum Assessment Scheme

| Mode                                                                           | Duration | Exam Mark | Converted to | Tentative Schedule |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-----------|--------------|--------------------|
| Total CIE: 40 marks (converted from 100+ internal marks) · Total ESE: 60 marks |          |           |              |                    |

| Mode                                                                                         | Duration  | Exam Mark | Converted to | Tentative Schedule |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|--------------|--------------------|
| Attendance                                                                                   | —         | —         | 5            | End of semester    |
| CA1 — Average of Self-learning activities from each module                                   | —         | 15        | 5            | By 4th week        |
| CA2 — Continuous evaluation                                                                  | —         | 40        | 10           | By 7th week        |
| CA3 — Practical test (first half of experiments)                                             | 2 hours   | 40        | 10           | By 11th week       |
| CA4 — Practical test (second half of experiments)                                            | 2 hours   | 50        | 10           | By 14th week       |
| CA5 — Series Exam (2 modules)                                                                | 2.5 hours | 50        | 10           | 8th week           |
| Series Exam (2 modules)                                                                      | 2.5 hours | 60        | 10           | 15th week          |
| ESE — Written Exam (theory)                                                                  | —         | 40        | —            | End of semester    |
| ESE — Lab Examination (internal)                                                             | 3 hours   | 60        | —            | End of semester    |
| <b>Total CIE:</b> 40 marks (converted from 100+ internal marks) · <b>Total ESE:</b> 60 marks |           |           |              |                    |

## Continuous Internal Evaluation (CIE) — Practical

### Scheme of Evaluation — Practical (Continuous Internal Evaluation)

| Criteria                           | Description                                                   | Marks     |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Preparation & Practice             | Regular practice, completion of exercises, record maintenance | 10        |
| Observation & Data Recording       | Correct outlines, proper use of rules                         | 5         |
| Analysis & Result Interpretation   | Accuracy in converting shorthand to longhand                  | 10        |
| Viva Voce / Concept Understanding  | Grammalogues, phraseography, loops, hooks                     | 10        |
| Workmanship, Discipline & Teamwork | Understanding of theory and rules                             | 5         |
| Discipline & Consistency           | Attendance, punctuality, engagement                           | 10        |
| <b>Total</b>                       |                                                               | <b>50</b> |

## Practical Test Evaluation

### Scheme of Evaluation — Practical Test

| Category                                | Things to Evaluate                                                                                                    | Marks |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Write-up / Procedure                    | Aim of the exercise, knowledge of shorthand rules, readiness for the test                                             | 10    |
| Shorthand Writing (Dictation Execution) | Speed in writing (WPM), ability to follow dictation accurately, proper formation of outlines, neatness and legibility | 5     |
| Transcription / Output                  | Accuracy in converting shorthand to longhand, correct spelling, punctuation, completeness of passage                  | 8     |

| Category                  | Things to Evaluate                                                                              | Marks     |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Application of Techniques | Use of grammalogues, phraseography, loops, hooks, shun forms, aspirates appropriately           | 8         |
| Viva Voce                 | Understanding of shorthand principles, ability to explain outlines, theoretical knowledge       | 4         |
| Record                    | Completion and neatness of shorthand notebook, regular practice exercises, proper certification | 5         |
| <b>Total</b>              |                                                                                                 | <b>40</b> |

## Series Examination Pattern — Theory

Series Exam Pattern

| Time    | Module              | Part A (Marks) | Part B (Marks) | Part C With Choice (Marks) | Total |   |    |
|---------|---------------------|----------------|----------------|----------------------------|-------|---|----|
| 2 hours | Any two modules     | 21             | 33             | 27                         | 25    |   |    |
|         | Any two modules     | 21             | 33             | 22                         | 25    |   |    |
|         | Number of Questions |                |                | 4                          | 6     | 4 | 50 |

## ? Module-wise Questions with Answers

Practice questions for each module to test your understanding.

### Module I — Phonography System

**Q:**What is the phonographic system? Explain its principles.

The phonographic system is the foundation of Pitman Shorthand. It is a **phonetic** system — words are written as they sound, not as they are spelled.

#### Principles:

- **Sound-based:** Each symbol represents a sound (phoneme), not a letter.
- **Light and heavy strokes:** Differentiate voiced and unvoiced sounds.
- **Position writing:** Vowels are indicated by the position of the stroke relative to the line of writing.
- **Consonantal skeleton:** The outline represents the consonants of a word; vowels are added as needed.

**Example:** "cat" = K + T with vowel placement for A.

**Q:**Describe the arrangement of consonants in Pitman Shorthand. Explain the classes and groups.

Consonants are arranged in **pairs** of light and heavy strokes:

- **Light strokes** represent unvoiced consonants (P, T, CH, K, F, TH, S, SH)
  - **Heavy strokes** represent voiced consonants (B, D, J, G, V, DH, Z, ZH)
- Classes based on articulation:** Labials (P/B), Dentals (T/D), Gutturals (K/G), Palatals (CH/J), Labio-dentals (F/V), Dento-labials (TH/DH), Sibilants (S/Z/SH/ZH).

**Q:What are vowel signs? Explain the three positions of placing vowel signs with examples.**

Vowels are represented by **dots** and **dashes** placed in specific positions relative to the consonant stroke.

**Three positions:**

- **First position:** Before the stroke (beginning of word) — e.g., "ate"
- **Second position:** At the stroke (middle of word) — e.g., "bat"
- **Third position:** After the stroke (end of word) — e.g., "bait"

**Example:** "be" = B stroke + light dot (ē) at the stroke.

**Q:What are grammalogues? Give examples of common grammalogues and their shorthand signs.**

**Grammalogues** are frequently occurring words represented by a single shorthand sign.

**Examples:**

- and — Light slanting stroke
- of — Light horizontal stroke
- for — Heavy slanting stroke
- to — Light tick
- with — Circle
- the — Heavy tick
- you — Light stroke
- I — Light stroke

## **Module II — Alternatives, Diphthongs, Phraseography, Circles**

**Q:Explain the alternative forms of R and H in Pitman Shorthand.**

**Alternative forms of R:**

- Regular R — Curved stroke
- R Hook — Small hook added to a stroke for R after a consonant
- R Circle — Circle used in certain combinations
- R Upward — Used in words like "are"

**Alternative forms of H:**

- Regular H — Light downward stroke
- H Hook — Hook added to a stroke for H before a vowel
- Aspirate H — Specific stroke for aspirated H

**Example:** "try" = T + R hook; "who" = H stroke + circle.

**Q:What are diphthongs and triphones? Give examples of each with their shorthand representations.**

**Diphthongs** are vowel glides from one vowel to another within the same syllable. Represented by two vowel signs joined by a light curve.

- ī (as in "ice") — Light dot + dash
- ou (as in "out") — Heavy dash + dot
- oi (as in "oil") — Dot + tick
- ow (as in "own") — Dash + tick

**Triphones** are three-vowel glides, represented by combining diphthong symbols with an additional vowel sign.

**Q:Explain phraseography. What are the principles and qualities of good phraseograms?**

**Phraseography** is writing two or more words as one outline (a phraseogram).

**Principles:**

- Common phrases as one unit — "I am", "you will", "in the"
- Combine grammalogues — "and the", "of the"
- Position writing indicates overall meaning
- Intersecting or touching strokes form phraseograms

**Qualities of good phraseograms:** Legibility, speed, consistency, distinctiveness.

**Example:** "I am" = light stroke for "I" + heavy stroke for "am" (combined).

**Q:Compare circle S and Z with stroke S and Z. When is each used?**

**Circle S/Z:** Used when S/Z is an "extra" sound, often at the end of a word.

- Example: "books" = B + K + circle S
- Small circle = S or Z; Large circle = S + Z together

**Stroke S/Z:** Used when S/Z is the main consonant.

- Example: "see" = S stroke + vowel placement
- Used in words beginning with S or in certain combinations

## **Module III — Loops and Hooks**

**Q:What are loops in Pitman Shorthand? Explain their initial, medial, and final positions.**

**Loops** are curved extensions added to strokes to represent certain consonant combinations.

- **Initial loop:** Beginning of stroke — represents ST or STR — Example: "stay"
- **Medial loop:** Middle of stroke — represents R or L
- **Final loop:** End of stroke — represents TR or DR — Example: "better" (B + T + loop)

**Q:Explain initial hooks and final hooks with examples. What are the alternative forms FR and VR?**

**Initial hooks** — added at the beginning of a stroke, represent R, L, or W.

- Example: "pray" = P + initial R hook; "play" = P + initial L hook  
**Final hooks** — added at the end of a stroke, represent R, L, N, or F/V.
- Example: "maker" = M + K + final R hook; "fable" = F + B + final L hook  
**FR alternative:** F stroke with initial R hook — "free"  
**VR alternative:** V stroke with initial R hook — "very"

**Q: How are circles or loops written preceding initial hooks? Give examples.**

When a circle (S/Z) or loop (ST/STR) precedes an initial hook:

- **Order:** Circle/Loop → Hook → Stroke
- Write the circle/loop first, then add the hook to the stroke

**Examples:**

- "spring" = S circle + P + R hook
- "strong" = ST loop + R hook
- "screen" = S circle + K + R hook

**Q: Explain N and F/V hooks to straight and curved strokes. How do they differ?**

**N hook** — represents N or EN/ON:

- To straight strokes: same side as circle
- To curved strokes: inner curve
- Example: "pen" = P + N hook

**F/V hook** — represents F or V:

- To straight strokes: opposite side from circle
- To curved strokes: outer curve
- Example: "have" = H + V hook

**Key distinction:** N hook and F/V hook are on *opposite* sides of straight strokes.

## **Module IV — Shun Hooks and Aspirates**

**Q: Explain the principles covering shun hooks. Give examples of words with shun hooks.**

**Shun hooks** represent the sound -tion, -sion, -ssion, -cian, -tian.

**Principles:**

- The "shun" sound is a final hook on the last consonant stroke
- The hook is placed on the *opposite side* from the circle (if present)
- Words ending with "-tion": consonant stroke + shun hook

**Examples:**

- "nation" = N + shun hook (opposite side)
- "mission" = M + circle (S) + shun hook
- "physician" = F + SH stroke + shun hook

**Q: What are aspirates in shorthand? Explain their different forms with examples.**

**Aspirates** are sounds produced with a breath of air (like 'h').

### Forms:

- **Regular H:** Light downward stroke — "hat", "him"
- **H Hook:** Hook added to a stroke — "who", "whom"
- **Aspirate with vowel:** H stroke with vowel sign — "her"
- **Note:** Silent H (hour, honest, heir) — no aspirate sign.

**Q:** Describe the principles of essay writing in shorthand. What are the key requirements?

### Principles of essay writing in shorthand:

- **Write in phrases:** Use phraseography to increase speed
- **Use grammalogues:** Apply all grammalogues correctly
- **Maintain position:** Consistent vowel placement
- **Review and proofread:** Check transcription

### Key requirements:

- Topic understanding
- Planning and outlining key points
- Structure: Introduction → Body (3-4 paragraphs) → Conclusion
- Maintain consistent speed while ensuring legibility
- Accuracy in transcription



## Practice Model Paper

Based on the official pattern (not an official SITTTTR model question paper).

### Shorthand English Theory I — Model Examination

**Time:** 2.5 hours | **Total Marks:** 50

#### Part A — Short Answers (4 × 3 = 12 marks)

1. What is the phonographic system? List its key principles. (3)
2. Explain the three positions of vowel signs with examples. (3)
3. What are grammalogues? Give four examples. (3)
4. Write short notes on diphthongs. (3)

#### Part B — Medium Answers (3 × 6 = 18 marks)

1. Explain phraseography with its principles and qualities of good phraseograms. (6)
2. Describe the use of circles (S and Z) in shorthand. Compare circle S with stroke S. (6)
3. Explain loops — initial, medial, and final positions — with examples. (6)

#### Part C — Long Answers (2 × 10 = 20 marks) (Choose any 2)

1. Explain the principles of shun hooks with at least five examples. (10)
2. Describe initial and final hooks in detail. Include alternative forms FR and VR. (10)
3. Write an essay in shorthand on any one of the following topics: (10)
  - (a) Advantages of shorthand in modern offices



**Note:** This is a practice model paper for revision purposes. The actual examination pattern may vary. Practice all modules thoroughly.

## ⚡ Quick Revision

Key points from each module for last-minute revision.

### ■ Module I — Foundations

- **Phonography:** Sound-based writing — "write what you hear"
- **Consonants:** Light (unvoiced) ↔ Heavy (voiced) pairs
- **Vowels:** Dots and dashes in 3 positions (before/at/after stroke)
- **Grammalogues:** Single-sign common words — and, of, for, to, with, the, you, I
- **Practice:** Exercises 1-12

### ■ Module II — Alternatives, Diphthongs, Phraseography

- **R alternatives:** Regular R, R hook, R circle, R upward
- **H alternatives:** Regular H, H hook, aspirate H
- **Diphthongs:** ī (ice), ou (out), oi (oil), ow (own)
- **Phraseography:** Two+ words as one outline
- **Circle S/Z:** Small (S/Z), Large (S+Z)
- **Practice:** Exercises 13-34

### ■ Module III — Loops & Hooks

- **Loops:** Initial (ST/STR), Medial (R/L), Final (TR/DR)
- **Hooks:** Initial (R/L/W), Final (R/L/N/F/V)
- **FR/VR:** F/V + R hook alternatives
- **Circle/Loop + Hook:** Circle/Loop first, then hook
- **N hook vs F/V hook:** Opposite sides of straight strokes
- **Practice:** Exercises 35-58

### ■ Module IV — Shun Hooks & Aspirates

- **Shun hooks:** -tion, -sion, -ssion — final hook (opposite side)
- **Aspirates:** Regular H, H hook, aspirate + vowel
- **Silent H:** hour, honest — no aspirate sign
- **Essay writing:** Structure, speed, accuracy
- **Practice:** Exercises 59-67

### ⚠ Common Mistakes to Avoid

- ❌ **Confusing light and heavy strokes** — Light = unvoiced, Heavy = voiced
- ❌ **Incorrect vowel placement** — Position 1/2/3 changes the word meaning

- **✗ Wrong side for hooks** — N hook and F/V hook are on opposite sides
- **✗ Missing silent H** — No aspirate sign for silent H words
- **✗ Circle order with hooks** — Circle/Loop first, then hook
- **✗ Inconsistent phraseograms** — Must be legible and consistent

### ✓ Exam Checklist

- ☐ Know all 50+ common grammalogues
- ☐ Understand vowel positions with examples
- ☐ Practice circle S/Z in different positions
- ☐ Master initial and final hooks
- ☐ Practice shun hooks with at least 10 examples
- ☐ Review phraseography — 10 common phraseograms
- ☐ Practice transcription speed (target: 60–80 WPM)



## Glossary

### Important Shorthand Terminology

| Term                 | Meaning                                                 |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Phonography</b>   | Sound-based writing system; writing words as they sound |
| <b>Consonant</b>     | Speech sound with partial/complete vocal tract closure  |
| <b>Vowel</b>         | Speech sound with open vocal tract                      |
| <b>Grammologue</b>   | Common word represented by a single shorthand sign      |
| <b>Diphthong</b>     | Glide from one vowel to another within a syllable       |
| <b>Triphone</b>      | Three-vowel glide within a syllable                     |
| <b>Phraseography</b> | Writing two or more words as one outline                |
| <b>Phraseogram</b>   | A single outline representing multiple words            |
| <b>Loop</b>          | Curved extension added to a stroke (ST/STR/TR/DR)       |
| <b>Hook</b>          | Small curved addition to a stroke (R/L/N/F/V)           |
| <b>Shun hook</b>     | Hook representing -tion, -sion, -ssion                  |
| <b>Aspirate</b>      | Sound produced with a breath of air ('h')               |
| <b>Stroke</b>        | A single shorthand sign representing a consonant        |
| <b>Outline</b>       | The complete shorthand representation of a word         |
| <b>Transcription</b> | Converting shorthand back to longhand                   |
| <b>WPM</b>           | Words Per Minute — shorthand writing speed              |



# Learning Resources



## Textbooks

- **Pitman Shorthand Instructor and Key** — Issac Pitman, Wheeler



## References

- **Enrich Your Theory** — Bhagavan Associates



## Web Resources

- Supplementary shorthand-learning reference currently unavailable; consult instructor-recommended resources. — All Modules
- — Modules II & IV